Derry:
How will you climb on a ladder and get the crab apples down, then?

Mr. Lamb:
Oh, there's a lot of things I've learned to do, and plenty of time for it. Years. I take it steady.

Derry:
Those other people who come here....do they talk to you? Ask you things?

Mr. Lamb:
Some do, some don't. I ask them. I like to learn.

Derry:
I don't believe in them. I don't think anybody ever comes. You're here all by yourself and miserable and no one would know if you were alive or dead and nobody cares.

Mr. Lamb: You think what you please.

Derry:
All right then, tell me some of their names.

Mr. Lamb:
What are names? Tom, Dick or Harry. [Getting up] I'm off down to the bees.

Derry: I think you're daft.... crazy....

Mr. Lamb: That's a good excuse.

Derry: What for? You don't talk sense.

Mr. Lamb:
Good excuse not to come back. And you've got a burned-up face, and that's other people's excuse.

Derry:
You're like the others, you like to say things like that. If you don't feel sorry for my face, you're frightened of it, and if you're not frightened, you think I'm ugly as a devil. I am a devil. Don't you? [*Shouts]*

[*Mr. Lamb does not reply. He has gone to his bees.]*

Derry:
[Quietly] No. You don't. I like it here. *[Pause. Derry gets up and shouts.]*

I'm going. But I'll come back. You see. You wait. I can run. I haven't got a tin leg. I'll be back.*[Derry runs off. Silence. The sounds of the garden again.]*

Mr. Lamb:
(to *himself*) There my dears. Ah .... you know. We all know. I'll come back. They never do, though... Not them. never do come back. (The garden noises fade)

SCENE TWO

Derry's house

Mother:
You think I don't know about him, you think. I haven't heard things?

Derry: You shouldn't believe all you hear.

Mother:
Been told. Warned. We've not lived here three months, but I know what there is to know and you're not to go back there.

Derry:
What are you afraid of? What do you think he is? An old man with a tin leg and he lives in a huge house without curtains and has a garden. And I want to be there, and sit and....listen to things. Listen and look.

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